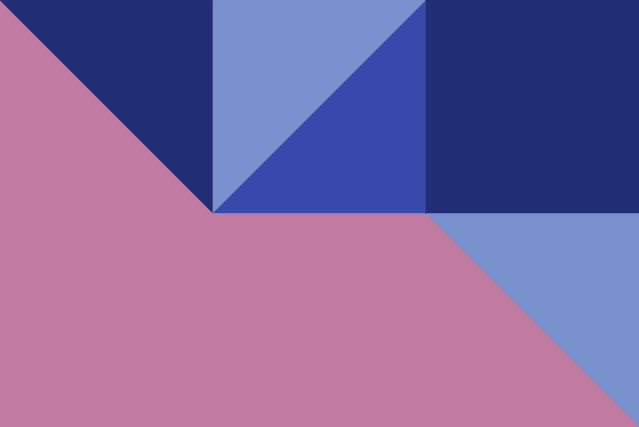




# Compare-Contrast Essay

# What is Compare-Contrast Essay?

A compare and contrast essay analyzes two subjects by either comparing them, contrasting them or both.



# Steps to Write a Compare-Contrast Essay

## **Step 1: Understand your assignment**

You need to look for keywords like similarities, differences, alike, two, parallels, and disparities to make sure that you need to write a compare and contrast essay. In some cases, your course instructor may only ask you to compare or contrast.

## **Step 2: Gather ideas**

The next step in the process is to start to brainstorm ideas. Find similarities or differences or even both depending on the requirement of the question. Find at least three controlling ideas (Three similarities/three differences/two differences and one similarity/two similarities and one difference)



# Continued

## **Step 3: Create a thesis statement**

The thesis statement should clearly state the subjects that are to be compared, contrasted or both. Introduce your main idea, using the terms "compare" and/or "contrast." Or, you can even use "similarities" and/or "dissimilarities/differences".

## **Step 4: Develop an outline**

Next, develop an outline for your essay.



# Continued

## **Step 5: Develop paragraphs that support your thesis**

The paragraphs in the body of your essay must support your thesis statement as is stated in the introduction. Develop your main idea, comprising either one of the subjects or one of the points of comparison, and provide evidence for the same. Explain how the comparison or contrast is valid.

## **Step 6: Use transition devices**

To blend details smoothly, use transitional words and phrases.



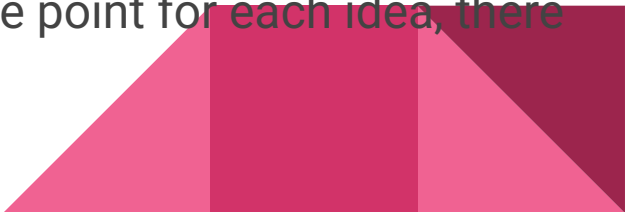
# The Structure of a Compare-Contrast Essay(Outline)

## Block Method

1. **Thesis Statement** (write based on two different ideas and one similar idea. If you mention contrasts before, write the comparing point later, or you can do vice versa)
2. **Supporting Detail 1**

Topic sentence (based on the first two controlling ideas relating to one subject in discussion)

Supporting points (use funnel approach and write one point for each idea, there will be total two points)



# Continued

## **Supporting Detail 2**

Topic sentence(based on the first two controlling ideas relating to the other subject in discussion)

Supporting points (same as before)

## **Supporting Detail 3**

Topic sentence (highlighting the only similarity/difference between the two subjects)

## **Conclusion**



# Continued

## Point-by-point

1. **Thesis statement** (same as before)
2. **Supporting Detail 1**

Topic sentence (based on the first controlling idea relating to both subjects in discussion)

Supporting points (use funnel approach and break down the first idea into two points)





# Continued

## 3. **Supporting Detail 2**

Topic sentence (based on the second controlling idea relating to both subjects in discussion)

Supporting points (use funnel approach and break down the second idea into two points)

## 4. **Supporting Detail 3** (same as before)

## 5. **Conclusion**



# Important Transitional Devices

## **Comparison**

compared with, in comparison with, in the same way/manner, in a similar vein, similarly

## **Contrast**

Besides, but, however, in contrast, instead, conversely, it may be the case that, nevertheless, on the contrary, on the other hand, alternatively, whereas, while, although, despite



THANK YOU!